



Fun & Games Desi Style

India's homegrown gaming renaissance

India's gaming ecosystem has evolved from casual board-game adaptations to high-end action and strategy titles that draw deeply on local culture and narratives. Ludo King transformed the classic pachisi board game into a global mobile phenomenon with over 1 billion downloads across platforms and 51 million daily active users during India's 2020 lockdown. FAUG: Domination, developed by DotNine Games and published by Nazara Publishing, launched at WAVES 2025 on May 2, demonstrating India's arrival on the global FPS stage by delivering a fast-paced, competitive military shooter set in iconic Indian locales. Boasting 5v5 Team Deathmatch, Sniper Duels, Weapon Race, and One-Shot Kill modes, the game has

already surpassed millions of downloads on Android within weeks of release.

Indie studios have also broken into PC/console markets: Pune-based Nodding Heads' Raji: An Ancient Epic earned acclaim for its art-direction rooted in Hindu mythology, averaging a 70 percent critic score on OpenCritic. On mobile strategy, Kurukshetra: Ascension (Studio Sirah) won Best Indie Game 2023 on Google Play for its Mahabharata-inspired card-battler mechanics. Sports titles like Real Cricket (Nautilus Mobile) boast 500 million+ downloads and award-winning realism, while Hitwicket Superstars – winner of the AatmaNirbhar App Challenge – offers a strategy-driven fantasy-cricket experience